

VERSION 2.0 - TORONTO PROOF OF CONCEPT

Product Vision + UX Guide

The adaptive nutrition execution system - product philosophy, behavioural model, experience architecture and next-iteration requirements

FOUNDING IDEA

Nutrics is not an ordering interface with nutrition filters. It is an adaptive execution system that turns a person's food intentions into a practical weekly plan, gets that plan cooked by standardized local production partners, learns from real-world feedback, and makes the next week easier.

Research snapshot: Toronto/GTA and behavioural-product evidence, updated August 8, 2026. Competitor prices, promotions and regulations can change; legal/compliance points are operating flags, not legal advice.

1. Product thesis

The category statement

Internally, Nutrics is an adaptive nutrition execution platform. Externally, the promise is simpler: “Your nutrition plan. Already cooked.” The moat is not a quiz, a macro calculator, a large menu or AI recommendations. Toronto competitors already offer versions of those. The product becomes distinctive when it closes the loop between intention, food, feedback and the next week. [R1-R5]

Nutrics should evolve from a transactional flow - profile → browse → order - into a weekly operating system: understand me → build a bounded plan → cook it → learn what actually worked → adapt the next week → recover gracefully when life changes.

The product is successful when the customer spends less mental effort on food while still feeling agency. The app should reduce planning, choice overload and repetitive decisions without turning into a surveillance dashboard or a guilt machine.

One sentence for each audience

Audience	What Nutrics is
Consumer	A weekly food plan that learns what works for you and arrives already cooked.
Investor	An adaptive nutrition execution platform that converts individual food preferences and goals into standardized, batchable production across local kitchens, then learns from real-world feedback to improve weekly fit.
Kitchen	Predictable, standardized batch production - not random marketplace tickets.
Nutrition professional	An execution layer that can help clients turn a plan into real meals without making the professional operate a food business.
Internal team	A system that must improve customer follow-through while preserving production and delivery economics.

2. The behaviour-change model

The behavioural thesis is not “people need more nutrition information.” Research on digital nutrition interventions suggests that goal/planning, feedback/monitoring and tailored support can help, and personalized nutrition has produced greater dietary behaviour change than generic advice in a large European RCT. JITAI research adds a useful principle: support should adapt to changing context and should not be delivered simply because the app can send it. [R13-R16]

Habit research also argues against brittle streak thinking. Habit automaticity develops through repetition in a reasonably stable context and varies widely by person; missing one opportunity does not necessarily derail the process. Nutrics should therefore reward return, not punish interruption. [R17-R18]

Behavioural design principles

Principle	What it means in Nutrics	UX implication
Reduce friction before adding motivation	Make the intended behaviour easier rather than asking for more willpower.	Default weekly plan, fast swaps, scheduled delivery, simple reheating, no repeated setup.
Stable rhythm + controlled novelty	Routine supports consistency; food still needs enough variety to avoid boredom.	Repeat proven favourites, introduce a limited number of new meals each week.
Autonomy without overload	People need agency, but unlimited choice creates work and destroys batch economics.	Give a recommended plan plus a compatible swap pool - not the entire catalogue.
Feedback should change something	Ratings are pointless if the next plan looks the same.	Show “what we changed because of your feedback.”
Recovery beats streaks	One rough week should not feel like failure.	Travel mode, pause, fewer-meals week, one-tap restart, no red broken-streak UI.
Support at decision points	Prompt when the user can act, not constantly.	Cutoff reminders, delivery changes, short weekly check-in; quiet otherwise.
Progress without obsession	The app should support routine, not compulsive monitoring.	Focus on meal coverage, plan fit, favourites and time saved; avoid punitive scores.
Explain the algorithm	Trust improves when adaptation is understandable.	Every recommendation can expose a short “why this is here.”

3. The North Star: sell consistency, measure follow-through

Core internal hypothesis

If Nutrics reduces weekly food-planning effort, gives people a plan that feels personally relevant, and adapts when that plan does not fit real life, customers will continue for more weeks than they would with a static prepared-meal subscription.

Metrics hierarchy

Level	Metric	Why it matters
North-star business	Retained Active Weeks per Customer	Measures whether Nutrics becomes a recurring routine rather than a trial.
Behaviour proxy	Plan Follow-Through Rate	Low-burden weekly answer: roughly what share of delivered Nutrics meals were actually eaten as intended?

Level	Metric	Why it matters
Product	Plan Acceptance Rate	How often a generated plan is accepted without major rebuilding.
Product	Swap Burden	Number of swaps/edits needed before the customer feels the week fits.
Product	Meal Fit Score	Taste + portion fit + schedule fit, not just a generic star rating.
Retention	Week 4 / Week 8 / Week 12 continuation	Separates novelty from real repeat behaviour.
Economics	Contribution margin per retained week	A habit that loses money is not a business.
Operations	Batch concentration + route density	Personalization must improve demand allocation, not fragment it.

Important: “adherence” is an internal product concept. Consumer language should be “consistency,” “fit,” “your routine,” and “what worked this week.” Nutrics should not present itself as measuring moral success or perfect compliance.

4. Product architecture: one platform, three coordinated layers

Layer	Purpose	What the customer sees
Experience layer	Profile, weekly plan, swaps, delivery, feedback, progress and exceptions.	A simple personal food system.
Decision layer	Recommendation, constraints, learning, demand concentration, production allocation.	Short explanations of why the plan fits; operations remain mostly invisible.
Execution layer	Standardized recipe versions, kitchens, batches, QA, labels, cold-chain and routing.	One consistent Nutrics standard across local culinary partners.

These are not three separate businesses. They are three layers of the same operating model. The consumer layer creates structured demand; the decision layer turns that demand into feasible plans; the execution layer manufactures and delivers the promise.

5. End-to-end user journey

Stage 1 - Intent: “What do you want Nutrics to make easier?”

- Start with the user’s problem, not biometrics. Examples: stop planning every meal; make workweeks easier; support a professional nutrition plan; eat more consistently; reduce takeout decisions.
- Ask only what changes the plan. Progressive disclosure beats a 30-question intake form.
- For the initial consumer product, make the service 18+ unless Nutrics later designs a professionally supervised minor pathway. This simplifies safety, consent and nutrition-goal design.

Stage 2 - Coverage: “Where should Nutrics fit in your week?”

- Choose meals-per-week and the meal occasions Nutrics should cover. Do not assume “10 meals” means the same routine for everyone.
- Capture schedule pattern: office days, home days, typical late nights, travel frequency, delivery constraints.

Stage 3 - Hard constraints

- Allergies and dietary exclusions are hard constraints, but the UX must be explicit that an app filter is not equivalent to an allergen-free kitchen. Kitchen cross-contact capabilities must be represented truthfully.
- Any medical or therapeutic plan should route to appropriate professional oversight rather than generic algorithmic advice.

Stage 4 - Taste and culture

- Collect positive preferences first: cuisines, proteins, spice, textures, favourites. Ask dislikes as exclusions or low-priority signals.
- Toronto’s diverse food culture is a product asset. Cultural variety should come through standardized local culinary production, not a catalogue so huge that batching collapses.

Stage 5 - Starter plan

- Generate a recommended week by default. The first useful moment is seeing a believable week, not a dashboard full of numbers.
- For each meal, show a short reason: “one of your preferred cuisines,” “repeats a meal you loved,” “new this week,” “fits your selected plan.”
- Let the user swap from a bounded compatibility pool. Show the plan impact of the swap in plain language.

Stage 6 - Commitment without a trap

- Default to a recurring weekly rhythm only with clear consent. Make skip, pause, travel mode and meal-count changes easy.
- A good subscription removes work; a bad subscription creates fear of forgetting to cancel.

Stage 7 - Delivery and consumption

- The home screen should prioritize what matters now: this week’s meals, storage/use-by guidance, next delivery, and any action deadline.
- Do not require meal logging for the system to function. Passive operational data + lightweight check-ins should carry most learning.

Stage 8 - Micro-feedback

- After a meal, one-tap feedback: Loved it / Good / Not for me. Optional reason chips: taste, portion, texture, spice, repetition, issue.
- Avoid long surveys after every meal. Ask more only when a signal matters.

Stage 9 - Weekly reflection

- A 20-30 second check-in before the next planning cutoff: “How did this week fit?” Great / Mostly / Rough week.

- Follow with one useful question: “What got in the way?” Too many meals, too few meals, schedule changed, food fit, delivery, other.
- Then immediately show the adaptation: “Next week we’ll send 8 instead of 10,” or “We’ll repeat more favourites and reduce new items.”

Stage 10 - Recovery

- If the user skips a week, do not reset progress or send guilt messaging. Offer “Resume my usual plan” as the easiest path back.
- If multiple weeks are skipped, ask what changed before discounting. The product should diagnose friction, not instantly buy retention with coupons.

6. Information architecture for the proof-of-concept app

Recommended bottom navigation

HOME | PLAN | EXPLORE | PROGRESS | PROFILE. The app should feel like a weekly planner with food inside it, not a restaurant marketplace with a health tab attached.

HOME - “What matters this week?”

- Hero card: “Your week is set” / “2 actions before cutoff.”
- Meals remaining this week, next delivery, storage guidance, quick issue reporting.
- Adaptation card: “We repeated 3 favourites and added 2 new meals based on last week.”
- Optional small insight: time saved, meals covered, favourite cuisines. No giant calorie ring by default.

PLAN - “What Nutrics will do next”

- Weekly plan grouped by day or meal occasion, with flexible slots rather than forcing exact daily perfection.
- Swap compatible, reduce/increase meal count, change delivery, travel/pause.
- “Why this plan” summary with 3-4 transparent reasons.

EXPLORE - “Controlled discovery”

- Curated meals available to this user and this production week.
- Filters for cuisine, dietary needs and favourites; do not expose impossible inventory.
- “Try next week” saves demand signals without promising production.

PROGRESS - “Consistency without judgment”

- Weeks active, approximate plan follow-through, favourite meals/cuisines, fewer emergency food decisions, time saved if measured.
- Show trend language like “More of your plan fit this month,” not “You failed 22% of your target.”
- If nutrition values are shown, make them transparent and non-punitive; avoid gamifying under-eating or rigid targets.

PROFILE - “What the system knows and what it may use”

- Preferences, exclusions, delivery, plan coverage, consent and data permissions.
- Explain each optional data source and why Nutrics wants it. Collect the minimum necessary; if connected to a regulated health provider, assess PHIPA roles and agreements carefully. [R12]

7. The adaptation engine: bounded personalization

The recommendation engine should optimize a feasible weekly plan, not an abstract “perfect diet.” Hard constraints always win. Soft preferences should compete with variety and operational feasibility.

Constraint class	Examples	Rule
Hard safety	Declared allergens/exclusions, kitchen compatibility, meal availability	Never violate. If no safe match exists, do not pretend.
Hard operations	Kitchen capacity, live recipe version, batch cutoff, delivery cell	Plan must be producible and deliverable.
User fit	Taste, cuisine, portion preference, schedule, favourites, dislikes	Maximize within feasible supply.
Nutrition fit	User-selected general plan or professional target ranges	Use ranges and explainability; avoid brittle “perfect macro” claims.
Variety	Repeat cadence, novelty tolerance	Create a stable core plus controlled exploration.
Economics	Minimum economic batch, ingredient availability, route density	Penalize fragmentation even when a meal is individually attractive.

Simple scoring model for the next prototype

Plan score

For each candidate weekly plan: $\text{USER FIT} + \text{PLAN FIT} + \text{VARIETY} + \text{LEARNING VALUE} + \text{OPERATIONAL EFFICIENCY} - \text{RISK PENALTIES}$. The customer never sees the equation; they see clear reasons. The engine should prefer a slightly less “perfect” nutritional match if it materially improves taste fit, batch concentration or reliability while remaining within safe/appropriate ranges.

Exploration vs exploitation

- Exploit: repeat meals the user reliably likes.
- Explore: introduce a small number of new meals from preferred cuisines or adjacent profiles.
- Do not surprise users with a high proportion of novel meals. Let novelty preference be explicit: Familiar / Balanced / Adventurous.

8. Core screens for the next mobile iteration

Screen	Primary job	Must contain	Do not do
Onboarding 1: Job	Capture problem	What should Nutrics make easier?	Lead with calorie math.
Onboarding 2: Week	Set coverage	Meals/week, occasions, schedule	Ask for every future exception.

Screen	Primary job	Must contain	Do not do
Onboarding 3: Needs	Set hard constraints	Dietary exclusions, allergen warning, professional-plan option	Imply allergy safety without kitchen validation.
Onboarding 4: Taste	Build preference vector	Cuisines, proteins, spice, dislikes	Make the user rate 80 foods.
Starter Plan	Create “aha” moment	Recommended week, why it fits, price, delivery	Drop user into a giant marketplace.
Plan Editor	Give bounded control	Swap pool, meal count, delivery, pause	Expose unavailable inventory.
Home	Reduce weekly mental load	Next action, meals, next delivery, adaptation summary	Show ten competing widgets.
Meal Detail	Build trust	Photo, ingredients, nutrition, allergens/cross-contact note, kitchen, use-by	Overclaim health outcomes.
Meal Feedback	Learn cheaply	3-state rating + optional reason	Long mandatory survey.
Weekly Check-in	Adapt	Fit question, friction reason, next-week change	Ask questions with no visible consequence.
Progress	Reinforce routine	Weeks, follow-through, favourites, time saved	Punitive streaks or body comparison.
Pause/Travel	Prevent churn	Dates, reduced box, skip, resume plan	Hide cancellation controls.

9. MVP / Phase 2 / Phase 3

Phase	Build now	Why
MVP - prove loop	Profile; bounded weekly plan; live inventory; swaps; recurring cadence; delivery slot; meal feedback; weekly check-in; plan adaptation rules; pause/travel; basic progress; issue reporting.	Tests whether a learning weekly system retains better than static ordering.
Phase 2 - improve learning	Preference confidence; novelty setting; portion tiers; recommendation explanations; friction classification; referral loop; nutrition-professional portal; experiment framework.	Makes adaptation smarter after evidence exists.

Phase	Build now	Why
Phase 3 - deeper context	Optional wearable/health integrations, calendar/context signals, advanced forecasting, city replication dashboard.	Only after consent, utility and operational value are proven. Do not collect data merely because it is available.

10. Product safety, trust and ethics

- No dark patterns: recurring plans must be easy to skip, pause or cancel.
- No guilt loops: avoid “you broke your streak,” red failure states or push-notification pressure.
- No casual medical claims. Food health claims and nutrient claims have regulated conditions; restaurant/takeout nutrition labelling has exemptions, but voluntary information still needs to be accurate and non-misleading. [R8-R10]
- If Nutrics uses the word “dietitian” in Ontario, ensure the person is registered; the title is restricted. [R11]
- Start 18+. If a future product serves minors, create a separately reviewed, professionally supervised experience rather than reusing adult goal-setting logic.
- Data minimization by design. Do not make precise weight/body data mandatory if a useful plan can be created from preferences, schedule, coverage and optional professional targets.
- Explain when a recommendation changed because of user feedback, kitchen availability or production constraints. Hidden operational substitutions can destroy trust.

11. Analytics and experiment plan

Experiment	Hypothesis	Primary measure	Failure signal
Default plan vs browse-first	A recommended week reduces decision burden.	Plan acceptance + time to checkout	Users rebuild most of the plan.
3-state feedback vs 5-star	Simpler feedback increases useful signal.	Feedback completion + predictive value	Signal too coarse to improve next week.
Adaptation summary	Showing what changed builds trust.	Acceptance of next plan + perceived relevance	Users ignore or distrust changes.
Novelty control	Explicit Familiar/Balanced/Adventurous reduces boredom and surprise.	Meal fit + repeat rate	No meaningful difference.
Travel/flex mode	A lighter exception flow prevents cancellation.	Pause-to-resume rate	Users cancel anyway.
Weekly check-in timing	A pre-cutoff check-in is more actionable than post-delivery engagement spam.	Completion + plan changes	Low completion / no retention lift.

Experiment	Hypothesis	Primary measure	Failure signal
Bounded swaps	Smaller compatible pool improves conversion and batch concentration.	Checkout conversion + SKU concentration	Perceived restriction harms conversion.

12. Data model the next build should anticipate

Object	Minimum fields
UserProfile	age_gate, household, preferred_name, locale, delivery_cell
PlanIntent	job_to_be_done, meals_per_week, meal_occasions, schedule_pattern, novelty_level
DietaryConstraint	type, severity, source, acknowledgement, kitchen_compatibility_required
Preference	cuisine, protein, spice, texture, meal_id, score, confidence
MealSKU	recipe_version, nutrition_snapshot, kitchen_capabilities, price, availability, tags
WeekPlan	week_id, meal_allocations, reasons, status, price, delivery_slot
FeedbackEvent	meal_id, sentiment, reason_codes, free_text_optional, timestamp
FrictionEvent	too_many, too_few, schedule, taste, portion, delivery, price, other
AdaptationDecision	input_signals, rule/model_version, change, explanation
ProductionConstraint	kitchen, recipe_version, min_batch, max_batch, cutoff, ingredient_status
ConsentRecord	data_purpose, source, version, timestamp, revocation
ExperimentAssignment	experiment_id, variant, exposure, outcome

13. Claude handoff - next-iteration product brief

Build target

Create a mobile proof of concept that makes Nutrics feel like a weekly autopilot with agency. The user should reach a believable recommended week quickly, be able to make bounded edits, understand why the plan fits, and see the system learn after a simple feedback loop.

Non-negotiable behaviours

- Home is week-first, not marketplace-first.
- Plan is generated by default from live feasible meals.
- Every meal recommendation can show a short reason.
- Swaps come from a compatibility pool and preserve hard constraints.
- Feedback changes the next plan and the UI explicitly says what changed.
- Pause/travel/reduce-meals is easier than cancellation.
- No punitive streaks, no body-comparison UI, no guilt language.
- Operations constraints exist in the model even if the prototype uses mock data.
- Allergen/cross-contact language is cautious and kitchen-specific.
- The app must remain useful even when the user gives no health-device data.

Design tone

Calm, food-forward, credible, warm and operationally competent. Think “the week is handled,” not “optimize yourself harder.” Photography and chef/cuisine storytelling should carry emotional appeal; progress screens should feel reassuring rather than clinical.

Prototype success test

Give the prototype to a new user with one sentence: “Set up Nutrics for your normal workweek.” If they naturally reach a weekly plan, understand what will happen next, can change it without fear, and can explain how Nutrics learns, the UX is doing its job.

Research references

Sources below support the market, behavioural-science, regulatory and product-design observations in this guide. Community discussions are explicitly treated as anecdotal language-mining, not population evidence.

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